unit 1

ا

alif

ـا

'a' in father when long

unit 1

ب

be

ـب ـبـ بـ

'b' in bat

unit 1

ک

kāf

ـک ـکـ کـ

'k' in kite

unit 1

ل

lām

ـل ـلـ لـ

'l' in log

unit 1

م

mīm

ـم ـمـ مـ

'm' in mat

unit 1

ن

nūn

ـن ـنـ نـ

'n' in net

unit 2

ت

te

ـت ـتـ تـ

soft dental 't', tongue on the teeth (Spanish 'tú')

unit 2

ی

choṭī ye

ـی ـیـ یـ

'y' in yes at the start

unit 2

ے

baṛī ye

ـے

'ay' in day

unit 3

پ

pe

ـپ ـپـ پـ

'p' in pat

unit 3

ٹ

ṭe

ـٹ ـٹـ ٹـ

hard English 't' in tap, tongue curled back

unit 3

ث

s̱e

ـث ـثـ ثـ

's' in sun (Arabic loanwords only)

unit 4

و

wāʾo

ـو

'w'/'v' at the start

unit 4

ر

re

ـر

tapped 'r' (Spanish 'pero')

unit 4

د

dāl

ـد

soft dental 'd', tongue on the teeth

unit 4

ہ

choṭī he (gol he)

ہ ـہـ ـہ

'h' in hat

unit 5

س

sīn

س ـسـ ـس

's' in sun

unit 5

ش

shīn

ش ـشـ ـش

'sh' in shop

unit 5

ج

jīm

ج ـجـ ـج

'j' in jam

unit 5

چ

che

چ ـچـ ـچ

'ch' in chair

unit 5

گ

gāf

گ ـگـ ـگ

'g' in go

unit 6

ں

nūn g̲hunna

ں

nasalises the vowel before it, like French 'bon'

unit 6

ھ

do-chashmī he

ھ ـھـ ـھ

a puff of breath after the letter before it: بھ bh, پھ ph, کھ kh, گھ gh…

unit 7

ڈ

ḍāl

ڈ

hard English 'd' in dad, tongue curled back

unit 7



ṛe

ڑ

a flapped 'r'/'d' made with the tongue curled back (no English match)

unit 7



ze

ز

'z' in zoo

unit 7



zhe

ژ

's' in pleasure (Persian loanwords only, rare)

unit 8



fe

ف ـفـ ـف

'f' in fat

unit 8



qāf

ق ـقـ ـق

a 'k' made far back in the throat (Arabic loanwords)

unit 8



k̲he

خ ـخـ ـخ

'ch' in Scottish loch

unit 8



g̲hain

غ ـغـ ـغ

a gargled 'g', like the French 'r'

unit 8



ʻain

ع ـعـ ـع

in Urdu it mostly just carries the vowel written around it (عمر umar)

unit 8



baṛī ḥe

ح ـحـ ـح

'h' in hat (Arabic loanwords)

unit 9

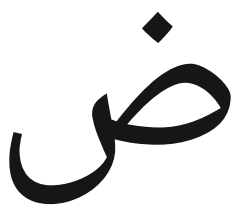


ṣwād

ص ـصـ ـص

's' in sun

unit 9

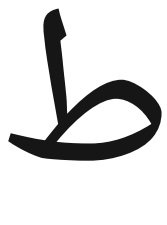


ẓwād

ض ـضـ ـض

'z' in zoo

unit 9



ṭo'e

ط ـطـ ـط

soft 't'

unit 9

ظ

ẓo'e

ظ ظ ظ

'z' in zoo

unit 9

ذ

ẕāl

ذ

'z' in zoo

unit 10

ىٔ

hamza

ىٔ ـئـ ـئ

a tiny break between two vowels (کوئی ko-ī). It rides on ی as ئ, on و as ؤ, or stands alone...